Le Tran Minh Dat

AI-NATIVE SOFTWARE ENGINEER · AGENTS · BACKEND · LLM INFRASTRUCTURE

Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam · +84 369 744 023 · datltmse@gmail.com · Remote-ready (GMT+7, async-first)
letranminhdat.com · github.com/letranminhdat1516 · linkedin.com/in/dat-le-139a85284

SUMMARY

AI-native software engineer who builds AI agents and the backend they run on, starting from the problem users actually feel. Since 2025 I have taken projects from an empty repository to production, on my own or leading teams of two to four: an AI gateway extension layer for a bank, an MCP commerce gateway, a voice ordering assistant, an admissions chatbot and a multi-company accounting platform. I plan my own milestones, write things down, keep going until it works, and stay to run what I ship. Next, I want to build a product of my own that helps a community and reaches people anywhere in the world.

EXPERIENCE

AI Gateway Platform Engineer · Enterprise Client (Banking) — Aug 2026 – Present

Outsourced contract · 2-engineer team · I built the extension layer and own delivery and planning; the lead engineer reviews and merges

The bank runs open-source LiteLLM as one AI gateway for its internal teams. It needed enterprise controls (spend that matches the AWS bill, audit, PII protection, access control) without commercially licensed code and without changing the LiteLLM core.

- Built a separate extension package and admin pages that add those controls on top of LiteLLM, so upstream releases still merge cleanly: a tamper-evident audit log (append-only, hash-chained, exportable to Sentinel), Vietnamese PII guardrails with a false-positive review flow, SSO and an auditor role.
- Built Bedrock cost reconciliation that checks gateway spend against invocation logs and the AWS bill (Athena) every day, by account, team, user and model, with Bedrock tax shown separately. Validating it line by line against the real invoice exposed and fixed a 4× over-count.
- Added cross-account access through assumed roles, budget-aware model downgrade, alerts by email, SES and SNS with editable templates, bulk onboarding from a spreadsheet, X-Ray-linked traces and Terraform for the AWS stack; wrote the architecture docs and runbooks for the handover.

Backend & AI Engineer · F&B and AI-Commerce Company — May 2026 – Present

Contract

Siz — AI Commerce Gateway (MCP) · Aug 2026 – Present · two-person product team; I built the gateway and its web app

Vietnamese merchants have no API an AI assistant can use, so agents can't book or buy on a user's behalf.

- Designed and built the MCP server in Go: booking tools that let assistants search and book cinema and flight tickets on real merchant sites.
- Made it safe to act for a user: account linking with OAuth 2.1 + PKCE, every merchant request signed with Ed25519 (RFC 9421) so merchants can verify it, and payment handed back to the user's own bank app through a verified VietQR. Siz never holds money.
- Built the Next.js web app and an AI-Ready scorer that crawls merchant sites and grades how usable they are for agents; shipped through GitOps to k3s.

Bảo Bối — voice ordering assistant · May 2026 – Present

A café wanted customers to order by talking, without waiting for staff at peak hours.

- Built the ordering flow end to end: chat and real-time voice (LiveKit, speech-to-text, text-to-speech), drink suggestions by mood, and orders pushed to the café's POS with a VietQR to pay.
- Kept version 1 running in the café: a loop that turns bad replies into scenarios staff can approve, and a self-healing watchdog after a LiveKit outage went unnoticed for two weeks.
- Rebuilt it as version 2 for many shops: a Go core with per-shop isolation through PostgreSQL row-level security, a Python LiveKit agent, and safe fallbacks when Redis is down.

Co-founder · Zillexa — 2024 – Present

Independent dev studio · five members

- Co-founded a studio of five engineers that takes on product and AI builds and competes in hackathons as a team.

AI Agent Consultant Engineer · Hưởng Nghiệp Á Âu — Apr 2026 – Sep 2026

Freelance · sole developer · handed over

A 19-branch academy's advisors were buried in messages, and a chatbot must never invent a course or a price.

- Built a 24/7 admissions chatbot and an advisor cockpit on their live CRM. After each message it drafts three replies and a lead summary; advisors accepted 97% of the drafts.
- Grounded every answer: the CRM is the only source for prices and schedules, a course allow-list and topic pinning keep follow-ups on track, and hybrid RAG mixes pgvector with Vietnamese full-text search behind a provider-agnostic LLM layer.
- Ran it on-prem inside their network, with image reading through a self-hosted VLM (SSRF-protected) and nine end-to-end test suites before handover.

Core Full-stack Developer · Enterprise Accounting SaaS — 2025 – Sep 2026

Top contributor in a 3-engineer team · handed over

- Top contributor from the first commit on a multi-company accounting platform built to Circular 99/2025 and used daily by 20 accountants.
- Built consolidated financial reporting under Circular 202 end to end, with intercompany elimination and Excel export, plus fixed assets, loans and bank reconciliation.
- Made posting safe with atomic batch posting and period locking, and set up CI/CD from GitHub Actions to GHCR and Watchtower on the client's servers.

AI Team Lead, Computer Vision · Whammy Tech — Jun 2025 – Jan 2026

Contract · led 4 engineers

- Led a team of four (backend, frontend, mobile) and owned all AI work: fall and seizure detection on live RTSP cameras with YOLO pose estimation and LLM-written incident reports, running on-site on two real cameras.
- Added a rule that needs five frames in a row before alerting, which cut false alarms by 84% across 4,000 test cases.

Team Lead, Software Engineer · NEURADAO — Oct 2025

Contract · led 3 engineers

- Led three engineers from an empty repository to a live AI trading platform in 20 days: set the architecture and plan, wrote the trading logic, AI chatbot and automation backend (TypeScript, Python, PostgreSQL), and deployed on AWS.

IT Support Technician · FPT University IT — Jan 2022 – Dec 2024

Part-time, while studying

OPEN SOURCE

- **hotwatch** (github): fast system monitor in Go with a native UI for macOS, Windows and Linux, plus an agent for remote servers and Docker.
- **esp32-translator** (github): live English ↔ Vietnamese translation on an ESP32-S3 board, an iPhone and AirPods, fully on-device.

SKILLS

- **AI:** Claude Agent SDK, MCP, LiteLLM, RAG, pgvector, LiveKit, YOLO, OpenCV · Claude, OpenAI, Gemini, AWS Bedrock
- **Engineering:** TypeScript, Python, Go, SQL · Node.js, NestJS, React, Next.js · PostgreSQL, Redis · OAuth 2.1, REST, WebSocket
- **Cloud & Ops:** AWS (Bedrock, IAM, CloudWatch, Athena, SES, SNS, X-Ray), Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes (k3s), ArgoCD, GitHub Actions
- **Languages:** Vietnamese (native), English (written fluent, spoken intermediate)

EDUCATION & AWARDS

- **B.Eng. Software Engineering**, FPT University, Ho Chi Minh City · GPA 3.47/4.0 · 2026
- **Chord**, TOKEN2049 Origins Hackathon 2026 (Singapore): Runner-up on the main track, US$10k AWS credits
- **Viettel AI Race 2026**: Runner-up (Top 4), finalist out of 1,628 teams